AVC (3017.TW): Increasing liquid cooling penetration to drive growth ahead, capacity to expand 50% in 2027; Buy

Chao Wang
+886(2)2730-4195 | kuan-chao.wang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Taipei Branch

Allen Chang
+852-2978-2930 | allen.k.chang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C.

Al Wang
+886(2)2730-4081 | al.wang@gs.com
Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Taipei Branch

AVC reported 3Q26 results on Nov 10th. The core business (OPI) was 9%/5% above our estimates/BBG consensus, with OPM at 28.5%, 2.5/3.7ppts above GSe/BBG consensus. GM of 33.9% was 1.9/0.5ppts above our estimates/BBG consensus, mainly driven by improved product mix and better operational efficiency. Total revenue was in line with GSe but 2% above consensus, while net income was 11%/4% above GSe/consensus.

Going into 4Q26, we expect revenue to reach NT$65,070mn (+10% QoQ, +36% YoY), as we expect the solid YoY growth to continue to be driven by the server business, along with the ramp up of next gen GPU/ASIC servers. We expect GM to expand to 34.4% (+0.5ppts QoQ, +8.0ppts YoY), reflecting an ongoing improvement in product mix. For 2027, we expect revenue to grow 44% YoY, supported by new customer projects, increasing liquid cooling penetration and additional capacity expansion in Vietnam. Management expect to expand liquid cooling capacity by 50% in 2027, and guided capex to be NT$15/17bn in 2026/27, which supports the solid outlook for the liquid cooling business.

Overall, we maintain our Buy rating on AVC with a new 12-month TP of NT$4,820 (from NT$4,736).

3Q26 overview

AVC's 3Q26 revenue was NT$59,089mn, up 20% QoQ and up 52% YoY. GM expanded to 33.9% from 32.6% in 2Q26, while opex was NT$3,155mn, 10% below GSe but 2% above consensus. OP was NT$16,856mn and net income was NT$11,564mn, with EPS at NT$29.32.

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Exhibit 1: AVC 3Q26 results comp table

AVC (3017.TW)	3Q26			QoQ		YoY		Bloomberg consensus	
P&L (NT$mn)	Actual	GS est.	Diff (%)	2Q26	QoQ	3Q25	YoY	Consensus	%
Revenue	59,089	59,089	0%	49,121	20%	38,937	52%	57,719	2%
Gross profits	20,010	18,885	6%	15,999	25%	10,172	97%	19,236	4%
Operating profits	16,856	15,399	9%	13,324	27%	8,179	106%	16,115	5%
Pre-tax income	16,752	15,655	7%	13,935	20%	8,217	104%	16,320	3%
Net earnings	11,564	10,605	9%	9,567	21%	5,339	117%	11,155	4%
EPS, NT$	29.32	26.52	11%	23.92	23%	13.46	118%	28.27	4%
Gross margin (%)	33.9%	32.0%	1.9ppt	32.6%	1.3ppt	26.1%	7.7ppt	33.3%	0.5ppt
EBIT margin (%)	28.5%	26.1%	2.5ppt	27.1%	1.4ppt	21.0%	7.5ppt	27.9%	0.6ppt
Net margin (%)	19.6%	17.9%	1.6ppt	19.5%	0.1ppt	13.7%	5.9ppt	19.3%	0.2ppt

Source: Company data, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Earnings revision:

We revise up our 2026 earnings estimates by 6% to factor in 3Q26 results (we revise down our 2026E revenue estimates by 1%). We revise up 2028E earnings estimates by 1% to reflect a better product mix with higher contribution from the server business. We now expect the GM expansion to be faster due to the higher server business contribution, and thus revise up GPM by 1.2/0.3/0.4ppt in 2026/27/28E.

Exhibit 2: AVC earnings revision table

AVC P&L (NT$ mn)	2026E New	2026E Old	Diff.	2027E New	2027E Old	Diff.	2028E New	2028E Old	Diff.
Sales	222,318	225,305	-1%	320,020	319,723	0%	394,168	394,024	0%
Gross Profit	72,998	71,311	2%	107,786	106,740	1%	136,493	134,792	1%
EBIT	61,113	58,553	4%	89,865	88,836	1%	112,947	111,253	2%
Net Income	42,674	40,409	6%	62,013	61,901	0%	78,580	78,057	1%
EPS (NT$)	**108.41**	**101.06**	7%	**157.24**	**154.78**	2%	**199.24**	**195.18**	2%
Ratio analysis									
Gross margin	32.8%	31.7%	1.2pp	33.7%	33.4%	0.3pp	34.6%	34.2%	0.4pp
EBIT margin	27.5%	26.0%	1.5pp	28.1%	27.8%	0.3pp	28.7%	28.2%	0.4pp
Net margin	19.2%	17.9%	1.3pp	19.4%	19.4%	0.0pp	19.9%	19.8%	0.1pp

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation:

We reiterate our Buy rating on AVC with a new 12m TP of NT$4,820 (from NT$4,736), based on 30.6x 2027E P/E (which is above AVC's historical average +1 STDV. forward trading P/E, reflecting our positive view on AVC on the rising penetration rate of liquid-cooled AI servers), and factor in our latest earnings revision.

Investment thesis and Valuation & Risks

AVC is a global leading supplier of thermal solutions on Server, PC, Telecom and consumer electronics. We expect the company's cooling revenue contributions to grow to 66%/71%/74% in 2026/27/28E, driven by: (1) rising computing power of AI servers driving liquid cooling demand, (2) capacity ramp-up in Vietnam of 3D Vapor Chambers for GPUs and liquid cooling components, and (3) AI PC's launch in 2025, featuring more powerful CPU/ NPU/ Memory. We are Buy rated. Our target price is based on 2027E P/E of 30.6x which is higher than its past 5-yr avg.+1stv. of 11x, reflecting the product mix upgrade toward servers cooling / liquid cooling with stronger earnings growth and better margins, which we believe supports the higher valuation.

We are Buy rated on AVC with a 12m TP of NT$4,820, based on 30.6 2027E P/E, which is

above AVC's historical average +1 STDV. forward trading P/E, reflecting our positive view on AVC on the rising penetration rate of liquid-cooled AI servers.

Key downside risks: (1) slower-than-expected adoption of liquid cooling; (2) lower-than-expected demand for AI servers; (3) fiercer-than-expected competition; and (4) a slower-than-expected recovery in general servers.

3017.TW	12m Price Target: **NT$4,820.00**	Price: **NT$2,790.00**	Upside: **72.8%**

Buy

Market cap: NT$1.1tr / $32.6bn
Enterprise value: NT$1.0tr / $30.9bn
3m ADTV: NT$10.9bn / $340.6mn
Taiwan
Greater China Electronic Components
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (NT$ mn) New	**139,639.4**	**222,318.3**	**320,020.3**	**394,167.7**
Revenue (NT$ mn) Old	139,639.4	225,304.9	319,722.5	394,024.3
EBITDA (NT$ mn)	30,988.5	65,573.8	96,500.5	121,207.2
EPS (NT$) New	**49.17**	**108.41**	**157.24**	**199.24**
EPS (NT$) Old	48.24	101.06	154.78	195.18
P/E (X)	17.6	25.7	17.7	14.0
P/B (X)	7.7	16.2	10.7	7.5
Dividend yield (%)	2.4	1.6	2.4	3.0
CROCI (%)	160.7	210.7	221.3	205.2

	9/26	12/26E	3/27E	6/27E
EPS (NT$)	29.32	34.55	36.46	37.94

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 10 Nov 2026 close.

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Contributing Authors: Chao Wang Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Taipei Branch, Allen Chang Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Al Wang Goldman Sachs (Asia) L.L.C., Taipei Branch.

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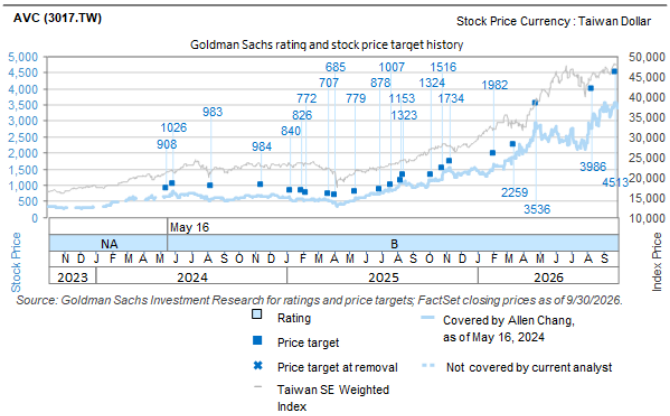
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AVC (3017.TW)

Date of report	Target price (NT$)	Closing price (NT$)
18-Oct-26	4,736.00	3,315.00
25-Sep-26	4,513.00	3,555.00
13-Aug-26	3,986.00	3,200.00
26-Apr-26	3,536.00	2,945.00
15-Mar-26	2,259.00	1,865.00
04-Feb-26	1,982.00	1,675.00
12-Nov-25	1,734.00	1,505.00
28-Oct-25	1,516.00	1,300.00
07-Oct-25	1,324.00	1,150.00
13-Aug-25	1,323.00	1,120.00
11-Aug-25	1,153.00	1,080.00
21-Jul-25	1,007.00	872.00
30-Jun-25	878.00	743.00
13-May-25	779.00	563.00
06-Apr-25	685.00	466.00
24-Mar-25	707.00	520.00
09-Feb-25	772.00	549.00
31-Jan-25	826.00	-
10-Jan-25	840.00	549.00
14-Nov-24	984.00	685.00
11-Aug-24	983.00	568.00
29-May-24	1,026.00	811.00
16-May-24	908.00	651.00

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